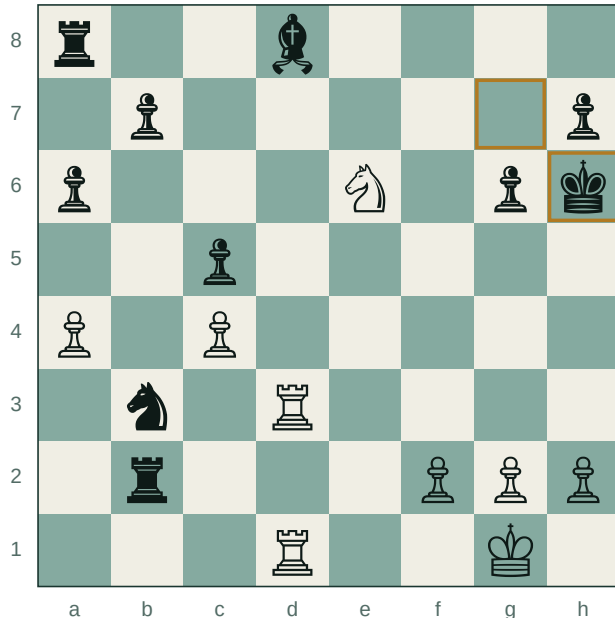


# Anastasia mating nets: White, move 27

Anastasia mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 26...Kh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**27. Rh3+ Bh4 28. Rxh4#**

**27.Rh3+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h3 it attacks king on h6 and knight on b3. Recorded reply: **27...Bh4**.

**28.Rxh4#** Mate: rook on h4 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on h6. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and rook on b2. Check for tactical protection.